

Read *Tom's morning* and answer questions 1 to 6.

Tom's morning

The alarm clock buzzed and Tom jumped out of bed. He had been looking forward to the School Sports Day for a long time. Now it had finally arrived.

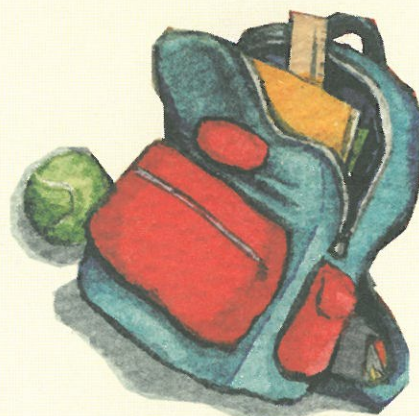




1. What is Tom doing in the picture?
(A) opening the curtains
(B) drinking some juice
(C) jumping on his bed
(D) stretching his arms
2. How did Tom feel about the School Sports Day?
(A) He was unsure how he felt.
(B) He could not wait for it to come.
(C) He wished it would never come.
(D) He thought it was an ordinary day.
3. Which option correctly matches the object with its location in the picture?

	Object	Location
(A)	jeans	bed
(B)	cap	window sill
(C)	watch	drawer
(D)	packet of juice	bedside table

4. What does the picture tell us about Tom?
(A) He has many pets.
(B) He plays several sports.
(C) He enjoys doing puzzles.
(D) He keeps his bedroom neat and tidy.
5. What is Tom most likely to do next?
(A) get dressed
(B) read a book
(C) go back to sleep
(D) do his homework
6. The word 'finally', as it is used in the text, means
(A) lastly.
(B) for ever.
(C) at long last.
(D) in conclusion.



Read *Muttaborrasaurus* and answer questions 7 to 12.

MUTTABURRA

Quick! Hide!

Why?

Because a Muttaborra saw us.

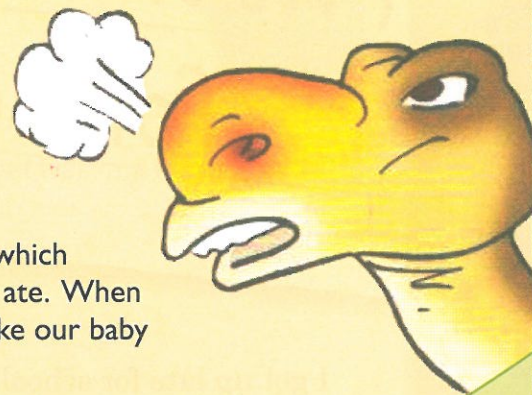
IT'S A WHAT?

A *Muttaborrasaurus* was discovered by farmer Doug Langdon on his property near the town of Muttaborra in Queensland. *Muttaborrasaurus* lived 100 million years ago, but Doug only found the dinosaur in 1963. By that time, the *Muttaborrasaurus*' bones had become fossilised—buried in sediments and turned to stone.

UTTABURRASAUROS

LOOK OUT BELLOW!

Muttaborrasaurus' skull shows a large, upwards-bulging muzzle that may have had a flap of skin over it. This could have been inflated for display, or to produce a blaring sound to scare off predators or call to other Muttaborrasauros.



NEED A DENTIST?

Tough teeth! Muttaborrasaurus had teeth that worked like a pair of shears, which could have been used to snap off the leaves of tough plants (cycads) that it ate. When its teeth fell out they were replaced all at once rather than one at a time like our baby teeth are.

To go with its tough teeth, Muttaborrasaurus had unusually strong jaws. Muttaborrasaurus could have chomped its teeth to scare off predators or other Muttaborrasauros.

7. Why was the dinosaur called *Muttaborrasaurus*?

- (A) It was named after the town of Muttaborra.
- (B) Muttaborrasaurus was where it was found.
- (C) The name sounded like 'Muttaborra saw us.'
- (D) All the other names for dinosaurs had been used.

8. The writer says 'It's a what?' because the Muttaborrasaurus

- (A) is extremely frightening.
- (B) is an uncommon dinosaur.
- (C) cannot be seen by humans.
- (D) cannot see into the distance.

9. The writer uses the word 'only' to emphasise

- (A) how old the *Muttaborrasaurus* was.
- (B) how long the *Muttaborrasaurus* could live for.
- (C) how long Doug took to find the *Muttaborrasaurus*.
- (D) how recently the *Muttaborrasaurus* was discovered.

10. When a word sounds like the thing it is describing, it is called onomatopoeia. Which word is an example of onomatopoeia?

- (A) 'muzzle'
- (B) 'teeth'
- (C) 'chomped'
- (D) 'scare'

11. Some words in the text are written in CAPITAL letters because

- (A) they are sub-headings.
- (B) they make the text look less boring.
- (C) they contain humorous expressions.
- (D) they emphasise important information.

12. What is the main purpose of this text?

- (A) to explain
- (B) to describe
- (C) to tell a story
- (D) to give an opinion

Read 'I'm late for school' and answer questions 13 to 18.

'I'm late for school'

I got up late for school today,
And nearly missed the bus!
I hurried down the stairs,
Wolfed my toast, and caused a fuss!

I quickly threw books in my bag,
My pens, my lunch and shorts.
Grabbed my coat from out the cupboard,
Took my bat and ball for sports.

I slid across the kitchen floor,
And hopped around the cat!
Then expertly rolled over,
Jumped back up and grabbed my hat!

I belted out of our front door,
Spun round and swung it shut.
Saw the bus was waiting for me,
I felt I had time to strut!

I climbed aboard and then froze still,
And knew that things weren't right!
My friends fell down in fits of fun,
And pointed with delight!

My face went red, I couldn't breathe,
For in my haste I knew!
I'd forgotten to wear trousers,
Jumper, shirt, my socks and shoes!

Gareth Lancaster



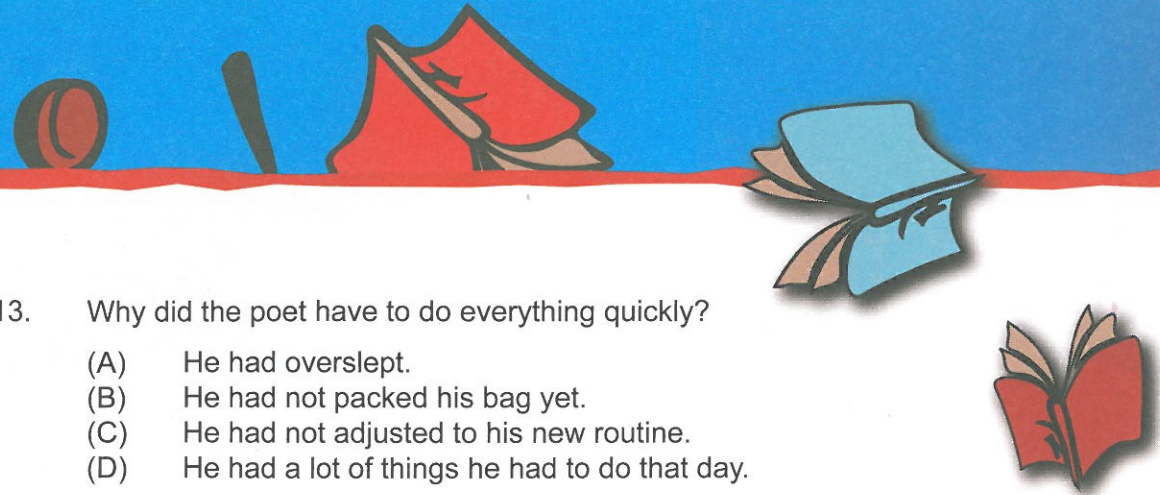
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10

15

20



- 
13. Why did the poet have to do everything quickly?
- (A) He had overslept.
 - (B) He had not packed his bag yet.
 - (C) He had not adjusted to his new routine.
 - (D) He had a lot of things he had to do that day.
14. Which word in the poem does **NOT** indicate that the poet was in a hurry?
- (A) 'slid' (line 9)
 - (B) 'grabbed' (line 12)
 - (C) 'belted' (line 13)
 - (D) 'strut' (line 16)
15. Which statement is true?
- (A) The poet forgot to eat his breakfast.
 - (B) The poet missed his usual bus to school.
 - (C) The poet fell over the cat as he left the kitchen.
 - (D) The poet remembered to collect his sports gear.
16. Alliteration is the repetition of the same sound at the beginning of words.
Which of the following is the best example of alliteration?
- (A) 'My pens, my lunch and shorts.'
 - (B) 'I slid across the kitchen floor'
 - (C) 'Saw the bus was waiting for me'
 - (D) 'My friends fell down in fits of fun'
17. How did the poet feel when he said, 'My face went red, I couldn't breathe'?
- (A) embarrassed
 - (B) disappointed
 - (C) confused
 - (D) amazed
18. Which lines of each stanza rhyme?
- (A) the first and second lines
 - (B) the first and third lines
 - (C) the second and third lines
 - (D) the second and fourth lines

Read *The tree was very high* and answer questions 19 to 24.

THE TREE WAS VERY HIGH

The tree was very high. Ava stood at the bottom and looked up. Its trunk was huge. It looked to her like a stone column of a huge old building. It had thick dark leaves and so many branches. Climbing up would be like solving a puzzle: where would she put her arms and feet next?

She glanced back at her father and her little brother in the playground. The playground was boring with her little brother. He just wanted to swing the whole time. Ava was restless; she wanted to do things that were exciting.

She pulled herself up onto the lowest branch. When she was by herself, Ava liked to imagine things—that she was another person, in another place. Now she imagined she was a sailor on a ship a hundred years ago. She pretended the captain had asked her to climb up to the crow's nest* to see if there was any land nearby.

'Right away, Captain,' said Ava inside her head.

She swung up to the next branch. Below her was the grey swirling ocean, deep with rocking waves. But Ava the sailor was brave. She took a deep breath and climbed even higher.

Now the world was far away. Over in the playground she could see her father and her little brother, still on the swing.

'Dad!' shouted Ava, proudly. 'Up here!'

But he couldn't hear her. Suddenly Ava realised how high up she was. She forgot she was a brave sailor and clung onto the branch.

'I guess this is what it's like to be a koala,' thought Ava, trembling. 'I wonder if they ever fall off.'

Slowly, carefully, she began to slide down. It was harder than going up, but Ava pretended she was a koala escaping from a bushfire. Instead of clothes and skin, she imagined herself covered with grey fur, and that she had claws instead of hands.

When she reached the ground with a thump, her heart was beating hard. She ran over to the swings and gave her little brother such a hug that he shouted in surprise.

* a lookout near the top of a ship's mast

19. The word 'swirling' means that the water is
- (A) full of fish.
 - (B) dark in colour.
 - (C) moving constantly.
 - (D) reflecting the sunlight.
20. Ava became aware that she had climbed very high up the tree when
- (A) she found it difficult to breathe.
 - (B) she forgot she was a brave sailor.
 - (C) the playground disappeared from sight.
 - (D) her father did not hear her calling to him.
21. Ava pretended she was a koala because
- (A) she believed that koalas never fell out of trees.
 - (B) she wanted to feel more secure about climbing down.
 - (C) she thought that she could see a bushfire in the distance.
 - (D) she guessed that koalas also trembled when they were frightened.
22. Ava hugged her little brother because
- (A) she was glad to be back on the ground again.
 - (B) she wanted to reassure him that she was alright.
 - (C) she was apologising for leaving him alone in the playground.
 - (D) she saw that he had missed her while she was climbing the tree.
23. Which words best describe Ava?
- (A) impatient but helpful
 - (B) imaginative but timid
 - (C) confident and daring
 - (D) honest and adventurous
24. The purpose of this text is to
- (A) illustrate the character of Ava.
 - (B) introduce the setting of a story.
 - (C) warn of the dangers of playing alone.
 - (D) explain the relationships in Ava's family.

Read *Bug buffet* and answer questions 25 to 32.

BUG buffet



Today's lunch will be fried grasshoppers, fresh fly larvae and spiced cockroaches, with honeyed locusts for dessert. It might sound disgusting, but it's a healthy meal.

You may not be ready to tuck into a big plate of crispy grasshoppers, but in many cultures eating insects is part of a normal diet—some insects are even a delicacy! People in Africa, Asia and Australia have eaten insects as part of their diet for thousands of years.

There are currently 1462 recorded species of edible insects, including ants, dragonflies, grasshoppers, termites and fly larvae. But why would anyone eat insects?

Insects are a good source of protein, and many contain minerals such as calcium, iron and zinc. Eating 100 grams of cooked caterpillar can provide more than your daily requirement of iron, copper, zinc and thiamin. Almost all insects have more iron than beef and fish, while dung beetles and termites have quite a high level of protein. Many insects are also lower in fat than beef, lamb, pork or chicken.

So what is the yummiest way to eat insects? Well, it depends on what you like. Insects can be fried, boiled, roasted, barbequed, stir-fried, ground up or freeze-dried. If you have a sweet tooth, you can get your insects in a lollipop.

Many insects are eaten as larvae but ants, grasshoppers and crickets are almost always eaten as adults. Grasshoppers are the most widely eaten insect and can be eaten salted or ground up and baked into a cake.

'Yuck, I'd never eat bugs,' I hear you say. Well, you may not know it, but you will probably eat half a kilogram of bugs in your lifetime or maybe even more. Insect body parts contaminate many everyday foods found in your kitchen. Dried foods such as flour and oats often contain insect eggs and if left at room temperature for long enough, these eggs will eventually hatch into larvae. Even chocolate can contain insect body parts!

Before you go out and start collecting bugs for your own buffet, there are a few rules you should know. First, brightly coloured insects such as some caterpillars should be avoided as they are likely to be poisonous. Second, insects that contain poison, such as wasps, must be boiled so the stinger and poison don't make you sick. Third, any insects sprayed with garden poisons and insecticides should not be eaten.

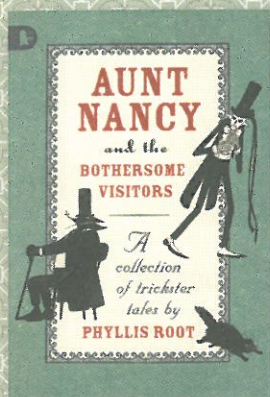
Finally, don't forget: if you decide to tuck into some tasty fly larvae, make sure that you share them with your friends.

Nutritional values

	Nutritional value per 100 grams	
	Protein (grams)	Iron (milligrams)
Dung beetle	17.2	7.7
Cricket	12.9	9.5
Grasshopper	14.3	3.0
Caterpillar	6.7	13.1
Termite	14.2	35.5
Weevil	6.7	13.1
Beef	27.4	3.5
Fish	28.5	1.0

25. The writer describes some insects as a 'delicacy'. This means that they are
- (A) very fragile.
 - (B) difficult to cook.
 - (C) commonly eaten.
 - (D) especially prized.
26. 'There are currently 1462 recorded species of edible insects, including ants, dragonflies, grasshoppers, termites and fly larvae.'
- Which option suggests that more species will probably be added to that list?
- (A) 'currently' (B) '1462' (C) 'edible' (D) 'including'
27. What feature of the table best highlights the nutritional value of insects compared with beef and fish?
- (A) the use of shading
 - (B) the list of different insects
 - (C) the even width of the columns
 - (D) the use of grams and milligrams
28. According to the table, which of the following statements is correct?
- (A) Beef contains more protein than fish.
 - (B) Fish contains more iron than caterpillars.
 - (C) Caterpillars contain more iron than weevils.
 - (D) Dung beetles contain more protein than termites.
29. Why does the writer say that 'you will probably eat half a kilogram of bugs in your lifetime'?
- (A) It is common for people to eat insects without knowing it.
 - (B) This is the quantity of insects that people require in their diet.
 - (C) Most people will eventually decide to try eating some insects.
 - (D) Being eaten by humans is part of the life cycle of some insects.
30. According to the text, which of the following statements about eating insects is correct?
- (A) All insects can be eaten if they are properly prepared.
 - (B) The grasshopper is the most popular insect eaten.
 - (C) All flying insects are made safe by boiling them.
 - (D) Only adult insects are eaten by people.
31. The tone of the final sentence is
- (A) humorous. (B) sarcastic. (C) demanding. (D) enthusiastic.
32. Throughout the text what does the writer assume about her readers?
- (A) They would like to experiment with eating insects.
 - (B) They have probably tried eating insects in the past.
 - (C) They would naturally dislike the idea of eating insects.
 - (D) They are looking for new ways to prepare insects to eat.

Bookshelf: reviews



Aunt Nancy and the Bothersome Visitors

by Phyllis Root

In this month's book, *Aunt Nancy and the Bothersome Visitors* by Phyllis Root, Aunt Nancy finds herself with visitors she'd like to say 'goodbye' to very quickly!

One of Aunt Nancy's bothersome visitors is Cousin Lazybones. You can guess from his name just what sort of a bother he is! Find out how Aunt Nancy deals with her 'fourth cousin three times removed on her great-aunt Hattie's sister's side'. I think you'll agree that Aunt Nancy is very clever.

You'll notice that in this book, the English sounds a bit odd. Sentences like 'Ezekiel the cat knowed what to do' sound like bad grammar to us, don't they? And how about 'Now, ain't that an idea?' If you said that, your teacher would probably tell you to talk properly!

The author, Phyllis Root, uses the type of English that many Americans who lived in the countryside used in their speech. You won't find it hard to understand what Aunt Nancy and her visitors are saying, and you might even have some fun trying to talk the same way. Now, ain't that an idea?

Reviewed by Suzanne Eggins

33. In the review of *Aunt Nancy and the Bothersome Visitors*, the word 'bothersome' means
- (A) sulky.
 - (B) irritating.
 - (C) miserable.
 - (D) uneducated.
34. What does the description of Cousin Lazybones tell the reader about him?
- (A) that he is a tall, thin person
 - (B) that he is slow but very clever
 - (C) that he is a distant relative of Aunt Nancy
 - (D) that he is great-aunt Hattie's sister's visitor
35. In the context of the review of *The Secret Garden* on page 13, the word 'fascinates' means
- (A) delights.
 - (B) amuses.
 - (C) comforts.
 - (D) enchants.

The Secret Garden by Frances Hodgson Burnett

Our Bookshelf novel this month, *The Secret Garden*, is simply bursting with secrets!

Mary Lennox is ten years old and has lived her entire life in India. But when her parents both die of cholera, she's sent to live in England, a country she's never seen, with an uncle she's never met, on a country estate just loaded with secrets. One of those secrets is a walled garden that has been locked away for ten whole years.

Mary is not a happy girl, and she doesn't have many interests. But when it comes to the mystery garden ... well, this garden fascinates her. And when Mary finds the key to the garden with the help of a mysterious red robin, then ... ah, but that's a secret you'll have to read the book to find out!

As you read the book, you'll enjoy the odd way that Dickon (one of the characters) talks—he speaks English the way they did in Yorkshire, England, in the 19th century. So, dig around in your library till you find the book. Read it and you'll find your own way into Mary's secret garden ... and into all the other secrets buried in this wonderful story.

Reviewed by Karen Jameyson



36. 'And when Mary finds the key to the garden with the help of a mysterious red robin, then ...'

The reviewer uses points of ellipsis (...) to

- (A) highlight that no one ever finds out about the secret garden.
- (B) show that she does not know what happens next.
- (C) indicate that she is unwilling to reveal the plot.
- (D) make the reader feel worried for Mary.

37. The reviewer thinks that the reader will enjoy *The Secret Garden* because

- (A) the author describes how to care for a garden.
- (B) the reader can learn how people lived in England.
- (C) the author takes you into Mary's world and its mysteries.
- (D) the reader discovers all about Mary's interests and friends.

38. Which of the following is common to both reviews?

- (A) All of the characters are listed.
- (B) The plots are described in great detail.
- (C) Different ways that some characters speak English are mentioned.
- (D) The reviewers suggest that some readers will find the books difficult to understand.

For questions 39 and 40 choose the sentence which is PUNCTUATED CORRECTLY.

39. (A) A Lion chased an Antelope across the African plains.
(B) He lives near the Rocky Mountains in the United States.
(C) We saw several dolphins swimming in the Pacific ocean.
(D) Earth is the third Planet from the Sun after Mercury and Venus.
40. (A) 'Throw me the ball shouted Jack! I'm over here.'
(B) 'Throw me the ball.' shouted Jack. 'I'm over here!'
(C) 'Throw me the ball!' shouted Jack. 'I'm over here!'
(D) 'Throw me the ball, shouted Jack!' 'I'm over here.'

For question 41 choose the best option.

41. Jim was about to hang out the laundry, just as he had promised his mother he would, when he heard his friends playing. Without stopping to tell anyone, he decided to leave to join his friends.

Which word best describes Jim?

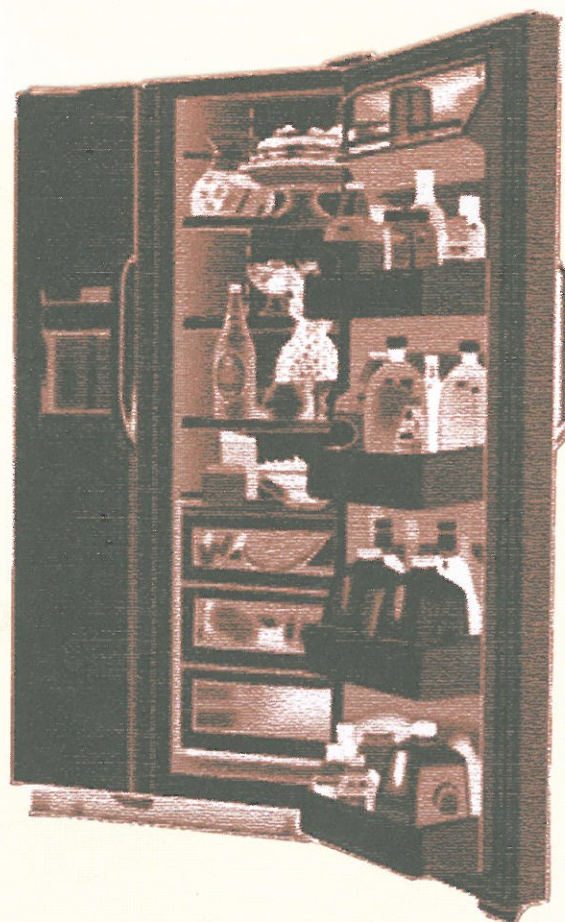
- (A) lazy
(B) impolite
(C) forgetful
(D) irresponsible



For questions 42 to 45 choose the correct option to complete this paragraph.

Food that is at room temperature soon _____ (42) _____ to break down and decay due to the action of bacteria and moulds. Refrigerators keep food cold _____ (43) _____ it lasts longer and keeps its flavour. Some types of food, such as milk and cheese, break down rapidly _____ (44) _____ they are refrigerated. Since refrigerators began to be used, the risk of contracting food-borne diseases _____ (45) _____ greatly reduced.

42. (A) start
(B) starts
(C) started
(D) starting
43. (A) where
(B) so that
(C) so as to
(D) as a result
44. (A) if not
(B) once
(C) unless
(D) despite
45. (A) will be
(B) has been
(C) had been
(D) have been





E

2012 English Answer Keys

ICAS
International Competitions
and Assessments for Schools

Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
1	D	A	B	A	B	A	D	A
2	B	B	D	A	D	D	C	C
3	A	A	D	C	D	C	A	B
4	B	C	B	C	D	B	C	B
5	A	D	B	A	C	D	C	C
6	C	A	C	B	B	B	B	A
7	A	A	B	A	C	D	D	D
8	B	D	D	A	A	C	A	A
9	D	A	B	D	B	D	D	D
10	C	A	A	B	A	A	D	D
11	A	D	C	C	A	C	A	A
12	B	A	A	A	C	B	C	C
13	A	B	C	D	D	A	D	D
14	D	A	A	B	B	C	A	C
15	D	C	A	C	C	D	C	A
16	D	C	D	B	D	C	D	B
17	A	B	B	D	A	A	A	A
18	D	B	C	C	D	D	B	A
19	C	C	A	B	A	B	B	B
20	D	D	D	C	A	C	D	B
21	B	D	B	A	C	B	B	B
22	A	A	C	D	B	B	A	A
23	C	D	D	B	C	C	B	A
24	A	C	C	B	B	D	B	D
25	D	B	B	A	B	A	C	D
26	A	A	C	D	C	B	A	B
27	A	C	B	B	D	A	A	B
28	D	C	A	A	A	B	D	C
29	A	B	B	B	C	B	A	D
30	B	C	D	D	A	C	B	C

(Please turn over)



E

2012 English Answer Keys

ICAS
International Competitions
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Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
31	A	B	D	C	C	A	D	A
32	C	B	C	A	D	A	D	D
33	B	D	C	D	B	D	D	A
34	C	B	C	B	B	A	D	C
35	D	A	D	B	C	B	A	D
36	C	C	A	C	C	C	C	D
37	C	A	C	D	B	D	B	A
38	C	C	A	A	B	A	A	B
39	B	B	B	D	B	A	C	C
40	C	C	D	A	D	A	B	C
41	D	C	B	A	D	C	A	B
42	B	D	B	C	B	B	C	D
43	B	D	C	D	A	C	D	C
44	C	A	A	C	D	C	C	D
45	B	D	A	D	D	D	B	D
46			D	D	D	D	C	B
47			A	B	D	C	D	D
48			B	D	A	B	C	C
49			D	A	C	C	D	A
50			C	C	B	D	A	D
51					B	A	B	A
52					A	B	A	D
53					C	A	B	A
54					B	D	C	C
55					A	C	B	B
56							D	C
57							B	B
58							A	C
59							A	A
60							B	B

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